

F5 Daily Briefing — Thursday, May 28, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS
TRACKED

19

ANNOUNCEMENTS

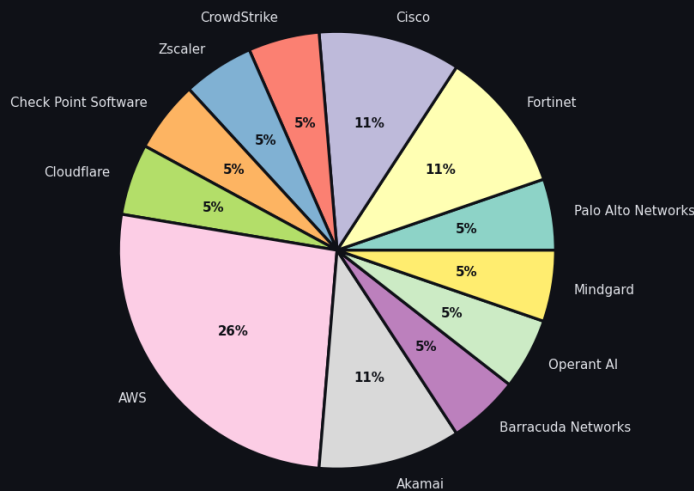
12

ACTIVE

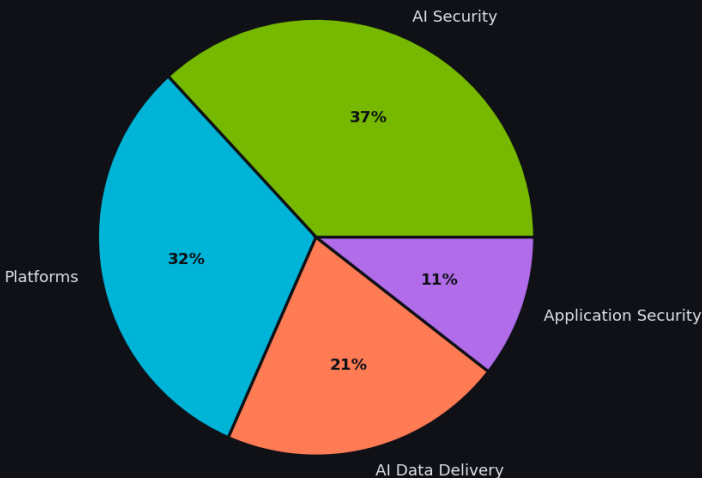
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (19)

ACQUISITION

Zscaler

2026-05-28

Zscaler to Acquire Symmetry Systems to Map and Secure AI Agents

Zscaler announced plans to acquire Symmetry Systems to enhance enterprise AI security by integrating Symmetry's access graph technology into the Zero Trust Exchange. The combined platform will map relationships among human and non-human identities, applications, and data sources, providing end-to-end visibility of AI agents, applications, and data interactions. This enables dynamic, least-privilege access policies and automated threat containment. CEO Jay Chaudhry emphasized that identity and data become the new security control plane in an era of AI-distributed resources, positioning Zscaler to govern agent-to-application and agent-to-agent communications at scale.

<https://cybermagazine.com/news/zscaler-acquires-symmetry-systems-to-map-secure-ai-agents>

PARTNERSHIP**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-28

Palo Alto Networks Partners with PwC on Frontier AI Defense Service

Palo Alto Networks announced a joint venture with PwC to bring a new Frontier AI Defense service to market, extending Unit 42's offering launched in April. The three-step PwC-led approach combines frontier AI exposure analysis, a threat-driven roadmap, and cyber defense transformation, integrating PwC's consulting with Palo Alto Networks' tools. The service addresses how AI accelerates vulnerability discovery and chains low-severity issues into high-impact attack paths, helping CISOs and boards bridge gaps between exposure management, testing, code review, and incident response.

<https://www.msspalert.com/brief/pwc-palo-alto-networks-target-ai-driven-vulnerability-discovery-with-frontier-ai-defense>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Operant AI**

2026-05-28

Operant AI Releases Operant Endpoint Protector for AI Tool and MCP Workflows

Operant AI announced the release of Operant Endpoint Protector, extending its AI Defense Platform to the endpoint. The new tool enables enterprise IT and security teams to discover, detect, and defend against threats across all AI tools, coding agents, and Model Context Protocol (MCP) workflows used by employees directly at the endpoint — where most AI activity occurs today. The release protects AI agents and MCP-connected processes from compromise or misuse, complementing Operant's existing AI Gatekeeper, MCP Gateway, and 3D Runtime Defense Platform offerings as enterprises grapple with sprawling shadow AI usage on user devices.

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/05/29/new-infosec-products-of-the-month-may-2026/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Mindgard**

2026-05-28

Mindgard Launches GuardBuster to Measure How AI Guardrails Perform in Real-World Environments

Mindgard launched GuardBuster, a new offering to independently evaluate AI guardrails and gateways in real-world, adversarial conditions. GuardBuster combines Mindgard's platform, research, and adversarial expertise to test guardrails against dynamic threats — prompt injection, jailbreaking, context manipulation, multi-turn deception, and adversarial ML evasion — outside lab benchmarks. The tool provides evidence-based assessment of how defenses perform in production-like environments, addressing gaps where current guardrails often underperform against real-world attackers. Mindgard positions GuardBuster as a way to help organizations measure risk, harden defenses, and move beyond vendor claims toward data-informed AI security decisions.

<https://finance.yahoo.com/sectors/technology/articles/mindgard-launches-guardbuster-measure-ai-130000353.html>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Fortinet**

2026-05-28

FortiClient EMS Critical Vulnerability CVE-2026-35616 Exploited in Active Attacks

Arctic Wolf reported an active exploit chain targeting Fortinet's FortiClient Endpoint Management Server via CVE-2026-35616, a critical (CVSS 9.1) unauthenticated access control bypass. Attackers bypass EMS authentication, modify VPN policies, and deploy the EKZ Infostealer disguised as a legitimate Fortinet endpoint update. CISA added the flaw to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities list and ordered federal agencies to patch immediately. Fortinet had released hotfixes for EMS 7.4.5 and 7.4.6, but thousands of publicly exposed instances remain unpatched. Organizations are urged to update immediately and restrict EMS management port 8013.

<https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hackers-exploit-forticlient-ems-flaw-to-push-infostealer-malware/>

PARTNERSHIP**Fortinet**

2026-05-28

Red Education Named Fortinet ATC Partner of the Year for APAC

Fortinet named Red Education its 2026 APAC Authorized Training Center Partner of the Year, recognizing leadership in Fortinet training and certifications across the region. Red Education trained the most individuals among APAC ATCs, contributing to Fortinet's certification programs, and has trained over 100,000 students in 132 countries with a 4.9/5 average rating from 5,000+ reviews. CEO Mike Baird highlighted the long-standing partnership and team effort behind expanding Fortinet's cybersecurity skills pipeline in the APAC region.

<https://www.einpresswire.com/article/915620490/red-education-named-fortinet-atc-partner-of-the-year-for-apac>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-05-28

CrowdStrike Expands Project QuiltWorks with Cyber Insurance Partners for Frontier AI Risk

CrowdStrike expanded Project QuiltWorks to include cyber-insurance leaders Coalition, Liberty Mutual, Lockton, Resilience, and Marsh, creating the first fully coordinated framework combining AI-driven vulnerability discovery, remediation, and financial risk mitigation. The expanded program adds actuarial and underwriting insight to enable insurers to underwrite frontier AI risk and provide financial mitigation for organizations. The framework prioritizes remediation beyond traditional CVSS scoring, helping boards understand frontier AI exposure and obtain financial protection alongside technical remediation across the AI threat lifecycle.

<https://undercodenews.com/crowdstrike-expands-project-quiltworks-to-tackle-the-financial-fallout-of-frontier-ai-cyber-threats/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-05-28

Cloudflare Adds Support for Claude Managed Agents

Cloudflare announced support for Anthropic's Claude Managed Agents, enabling developers to run and manage Claude agents within Cloudflare's edge infrastructure. The integration decouples Claude's orchestration from execution: Anthropic handles orchestration while Cloudflare handles code execution, secure connectivity, sandboxing, logs, and tools. Features include lightweight or VM execution, private service access via Workers VPC, browser session monitoring, and email capabilities. Launch lineup includes Cloudflare alongside Daytona, Modal, and Vercel, with Cloudflare offering Browser Run, quick-start templates, and first-class integration designed for regulated enterprises needing zero-trust policies and immutable audit logs.

<https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/05/cloudflare-claude-agents/>

PARTNERSHIP**Cisco**

2026-05-28

Cisco and OpenAI Partner to Embed Codex Into Enterprise Engineering

Cisco and OpenAI announced a partnership to embed OpenAI Codex into Cisco's engineering workflows, aiming to boost AI-native development, accelerate Cisco's AI Defense capabilities, and automate defect remediation. Codex will provide contextual code suggestions and automated fixes inside Cisco's product engineering pipelines, enabling faster, more reliable enterprise software delivery at scale. Cisco expects benefits including higher developer productivity, faster feature delivery, stronger security in shipped products, reduced downtime, and lower operational burden across its broad portfolio of networking and security platform products.

<https://www.aiwins.news/story/cisco-openai-supercharge-enterprise-engineering-with-codex-dc7077>

RESEARCH**Cisco**

2026-05-28

Cisco AI Threat Intelligence Finds Frontier AI Models Collapse Under Multi-Turn Attacks

Cisco's AI threat intelligence team published research showing frontier AI models are highly vulnerable to multi-turn, adaptive attacks. Testing 15 closed flagship models from OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, Amazon, and xAI across 30,000 single-turn prompts and 7,000 multi-turn attacks, Cisco found multi-turn attack success rates up to 88% — far higher than single-turn benchmarks predict. Over half of tested models showed at least a 15-point gap between single-turn and multi-turn results. Cisco recommends adversarial-success-rate reporting, regression checks, and manual review for models with cross-regime gaps.

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/05/28/cisco-multi-turn-ai-attacks/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Check Point Software**

2026-05-28

Check Point Launches Agentic Exposure Validation to Counter Autonomous AI Exploitation

Check Point Software launched Agentic Exposure Validation (AEV) for its Exposure Management platform, an AI-driven vulnerability validation tool that uses AI agents thinking like attackers to identify which exposures are truly exploitable. AEV correlates exposure data with asset context, live exploit research, threat intelligence, and existing protections in a safe proving loop rather than relying on static severity scores. Early customer engagements revealed novel exploits for vulnerabilities with no known prior exploits. AEV is now available within Check Point Exposure Management, advancing Continuous Threat Exposure Management toward evidence-based exposure reduction.

<https://ca.marketscreener.com/news/check-point-software-launches-agentic-exposure-validation-to-counter-frontier-ai-models-now-capable-ce7f5ddada8ff32c>

THREAT REPORT**Barracuda Networks**

2026-05-28

Barracuda Flags Stealthy Microsoft 365 Attacks, AI Lures, and Fileless Malware

Barracuda Networks released its May 2026 threat report highlighting attackers evading detection through stealthy Microsoft 365 logins, AI-themed lures, and fileless malware. Malicious M365 logins now appear low-risk by using VPNs and rapidly changing IPs from typically benign UK/US regions, up about 25%. A fake Claude AI installer redirected users to a near-duplicate site that triggered multi-stage PowerShell attacks with browser credential theft, C2 communication, and malicious certificates. Memory-resident clipboard execution avoids disk artifacts. Barracuda Managed XDR mitigated incidents with real-time intelligence, automation, and 24/7 SOC oversight.

<https://securitybrief.com.au/story/barracuda-flags-stealthy-microsoft-365-attack-shift>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Akamai**

2026-05-28

Akamai App & API Protector Hybrid Now Available on AWS Marketplace

Akamai announced that App & API Protector Hybrid is now available on AWS Marketplace, extending Akamai's WAF and Layer 7 DDoS protections into cloud environments and workloads that don't route through the edge. The hybrid solution offers multiple deployment modes — AWS Marketplace AMI in VPC, containerized security with NGINX/Istio/Envoy, and reverse proxy — to fit varied architectures. It enforces consistent policy across edge and non-edge environments via a single control plane (Akamai Control Center), aligns with AWS EDP for budget simplicity, and adds resilience as an independent defense layer during outages.

<https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/protections-without-compromise-akamais-waf-aws-marketplace>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Akamai**

2026-05-28

Akamai Launches AI Brand Presence to Boost Visibility in Agentic Search

Akamai launched AI Brand Presence, a new service that optimizes content for AI search and agentic traffic. It automatically translates website content for LLMs and AI agents, monitors AI bot activity, and provides edge security. In testing on Akamai's own site, the feature boosted brand visibility by 364%, with citations up 85% and AI bot traffic growing over 300% year over year. A single dashboard tracks which AI models visit, what content they consume, and resulting engagement, while reducing data loads for AI consumption. Initial availability is a phased North America rollout to select customers.

<https://cxotoday.com/ai/akamai-launches-ai-brand-presence-to-boost-visibility-in-agentic-search/>

PARTNERSHIP**AWS**

2026-05-28

Snowflake Commits \$6 Billion to AWS Over Five Years, Centered on Graviton

Snowflake announced a five-year, \$6 billion deal to expand its use of AWS, including running on AWS Graviton Arm-based CPUs and deeper product integrations for agentic enterprise workloads. The agreement, the largest expansion in their 11-year relationship, is roughly 5x Snowflake's 2020 commitment and 2.4x the 2023 deal. The Graviton emphasis marks a strategic endorsement of Arm-based servers in AWS, highlighting AWS's capacity to absorb new capacity amid AI infrastructure growth. The pact signals Snowflake's tilt toward a single-cloud strategy and customer acquisition via AWS Marketplace.

<https://thenextweb.com/news/snowflake-aws-6bn-graviton-ai-commitment>

CUSTOMER WIN**AWS**

2026-05-28

Thailand Immigration Bureau Modernizes Services with AWS

AWS announced that Thailand's Immigration Management System (THIM) is built on AWS. THIM, developed by Digital Identity Co. in partnership with the Thailand Immigration Bureau, is Thailand's first web and mobile national immigration management app. The pilot aims to reduce border wait times, enabling travelers to complete arrival cards in about three minutes. The architecture uses AWS services in the Asia Pacific (Bangkok) Region across three pillars to support faster borders, improved security, and better citizen experience for one of the world's most visited destinations.

<https://press.aboutamazon.com/aws/2026/5/digital-identity-co-modernizes-thailand-immigration-bureau-services-with-aws>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-05-28

AWS Launches Agentic Shopping Assistant for Retailers

AWS launched an agentic shopping assistant for retailers, built on AWS Bedrock, AgentCore, and OpenSearch and leveraging Amazon's own shopping technology. Retailers can create branded, conversational shopping assistants using their own catalogs, rules, and brand voice, with data hosted in their AWS accounts. Targeting roughly 60-day time-to-production, the service includes architecture, starter code, and advisory support via the AWS Generative AI Innovation Centre. Early example: Kate Spade (Tapestry) built an AI Gift Concierge focusing on occasion, recipient, and style to drive natural-dialogue product recommendations while retaining control of customer interactions.

<https://ecommercenews.asia/story/aws-launches-agentic-shopping-assistant-for-retailers>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-05-28

Claude Opus 4.8 Now Available on AWS

AWS announced that Anthropic's Claude Opus 4.8 — the latest, most capable general-availability model — is now available on AWS. Improvements include long autonomous runs, deeper reasoning, and greater reliability for production AI tasks, with notable gains in coding (reading codebases, planning before edits, maintaining session context), agentic tasks (overcoming obstacles, error recovery, knowing when to ask for help), and knowledge work (synthesizing long documents, self-checking, producing structured deliverables). Access is available via Amazon Bedrock with AWS data residency, Guardrails, and Knowledge Bases, plus the native Claude Platform on AWS via Console.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/05/claude-opus-4.8-aws/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

2026-05-28

AWS Announces Resilient Network Graphs for Faster, More Resilient AI Workloads

AWS announced Resilient Network Graphs, a quasi-random, flat mesh networking design intended to accelerate information flow across AWS infrastructure. The architecture changes traffic path establishment and connectivity behavior at scale to improve speed and resilience for distributed and cloud workloads, particularly AI training and inference. Benefits highlighted include lower latency, higher operational resilience, and better performance. AWS did not yet publish performance benchmarks or specify which services will adopt the architecture first, but framed the rollout as a foundational evolution of its data-center fabric to keep pace with AI infrastructure demand.

<https://alltcc.com/tech/what-did-aws-announce-about-resilient-network-graphs>